CASE STUDY

Google Ads Boost Occupancy

Full-funnel approach taps into Google Ads to drive apartment community's occupancy to pre-covid levels

adtaxi

Reaching Goals in a Changing Market

A property management company was faced with an apartment community's plummeting occupancy as a result of the area experiencing the largest population decline in the U.S. due to the pandemic. The property management company's marketing strategies were ineffective in reaching occupancy goals in the changing market, and the existing search volume was not enough to return occupancy to pre-covid levels.



After a thorough audit, Adtaxi's objective was to generate leads from the existing search volume and increase search volume by creating interest and awareness via upper funnel activity. Adtaxi leveraged the most from Google's three AI pillars: Bidding, Ads, and Targeting, also assigning conversion value/cost for the best way to measure the efficacy from a ROAS perspective.

Adtaxi's strategies harvested existing demand and also created awareness that generated additional demand from upper funnel actions. Tapping into Google's AI solutions boosted impressions, clicks, and leads with only 47% more budget, driving occupancy to pre-covid levels.

CHALLENGES

Digital and search campaigns not reaching occupancy goals

Occupancy decline a result of the pandemic

Crafting and implementing a more diverse full-funnel strategy

SOLUTIONS

Identified multiple stages of the buying journey for conversions

Tapped into a full-funnel approach across Google Ads to increase occupancy

Assigned conversion value/ cost to measure the efficacy from a ROAS perspective

RESULTS

172%
more impressions

137%
more clicks

163%
more leads

Falling Occupancy

An apartment community with 13,000 residential units ranging from studios to 5 bedrooms, is one of the largest apartment communities in the United States. Its occupancy plummeted as the area experienced the largest population decline in the U.S. during the pandemic, with a 6.9% decline in residents.

The Renter's Journey

Adtaxi was challenged to return occupancy to pre-covid levels, generally targeted at 95%, from the 79% they had fallen to over the course of the pandemic. The identified need to fill 2,000 vacant units, bringing occupancy up to 95% required Adtaxi's thoughtful analysis of a renter's buying journey in the changing market environment, and the creation of strategies to get there.

Search Volume

The marketing objective was developed with the understanding that, with a 6.9% population decline, the existing search volume wouldn't be enough to meet the business objective. Adtaxi's objective then became to generate leads from the existing search volume, and increase search volume by creating interest and awareness via upper funnel activity.

Google Solutions

Adtaxi leveraged as many of Google's AI solutions as possible, choosing a combination of products in order to allow for growth while leveraging the most from Google's three AI pillars: Bidding, Ads, and Targeting.

A Full-Funnel Strategy

In comparing the critical Q2 2022 results to Q2 2021 results: Q2 2022 delivered 172% more impressions, 137% more clicks, and 163% more leads with only 47% more budget. Implementing a full-funnel strategy, incorporating Performance Max and other machine learning components harvested existing demand and also created awareness that generated additional demand from upper funnel actions.

This full-funnel approach across products resulted in a 19.5% increase in occupancy, from 79.4% in 2021 to 94.5%. 1,963 additional units were occupied in June of 2022 than in June of 2021.



Key Insights

Rental revenue is influenced by available inventory, so using the assigned conversion value/cost was the best way to measure the efficacy from a ROAS perspective. Identifying multiple stages of the buying journey, and the importance of intermediate conversions towards the final outcome, allowed various values to be assigned to high, mid, and low funnel conversion actions.